

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥3

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥4

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣7

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦9

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 5 2
♥ 7
♦ J 9 4
♣ Q J 8 7 4

♠ J 6

♥ K Q 10 8 3 2

♦ A 7

♣ A K 3



♠ 10 9 7 4

♥ A 5

♦ K Q 10 5 3

♣ 10 2

♠ K Q 3

♥ J 9 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 9 6 5

SOUTH's 2♥ raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦K

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ J 7 5 4

♦ A 8

♣ 5 3 2



♠ A Q 4

♥ K 10 8

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ A J 6

♠ K 5 2

♥ Q 3 2

♦ 6 4 2

♣ Q 10 9 7

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening - 15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥3

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 3
♣ J 9 4

♠ Q J 6 4

♥ A 9 5

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 6 3



♠ 8 5

♥ J 8 7 2

♦ K Q 9 6

♣ Q 10 7

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K 6

♦ 10 7 5 4

♣ 8 5 2

With 6 points, SOUTH must respond to NORTH's 1♣ opening bid. While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", SOUTH should skip over the weak ♦ suit in favor of showing the 4-card Major ♠ suit.

NORTH knows that SOUTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2♠. With his minimum response hand SOUTH passes.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
2♠ by South			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 6
♥ A K Q 7 2
♦ A 5 3
♣ 6 4

♠ A 10 4 3

♥ J 5

♦ Q J 7

♣ Q 10 7 3



♠ 7 5

♥ 10 9 8 4

♦ K 9 4

♣ K 8 5 2

♠ K 9 8 2

♥ 6 3

♦ 10 8 6 2

♣ A J 9

With 17 points WEST is not strong enough to insist on game after EAST's raise, but is strong enough to invite with a 3♥ bid.

EAST, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

West

1♥

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by West

Lead: ♣7

North

Pass

East

2♥

South

Pass

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 5
♥ 6 5 3 2
♦ 10 4 3
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ A 8 3 2

♥ K 10 9

♦ A J 7

♣ K Q 6



♠ K J 7 6
♥ A 8 7
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 10 8 2

♠ 10 9 4

♥ Q J 4

♦ K Q 5 2

♣ J 9 5

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ 9			